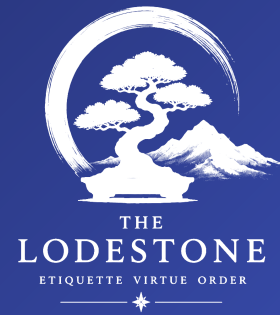


A PARENT'S GUIDE

Dysgraphia & Writing

When writing is a struggle, ideas get trapped. Here's how to help them flow.



Dysgraphia affects writing, the physical act of forming letters, getting ideas onto the page, or both. A child who avoids writing is rarely lazy; they often have plenty to say and need help getting it from head to hand. It is not about intelligence, and with the right support, writing gets easier and lighter.

Signs you might recognise

- ✓ Writes slowly and with effort, and says their hand hurts
- ✓ Forms letters awkwardly, with odd sizing and spacing
- ✓ Grips the pencil tightly or in an unusual way
- ✓ Has lots to say aloud, but freezes when asked to write
- ✓ Spells the same word several ways
- ✓ Has handwriting that is hard to read, even for them

What you can do at home

- **Strengthen little hands first.** Playdough, threading beads, Lego, tweezers and scissors build the fine-motor muscles writing relies on.
- **Get the tools right.** Try a chunky or triangular pencil, a pencil grip, a slanted surface, and lined or graph paper to guide letters.
- **Separate thinking from writing.** Let your child say or dictate their ideas first, then write, so handwriting and thinking don't compete.
- **Allow typing for longer pieces.** Typing isn't cheating, it lets ideas flow. Build handwriting separately, in short bursts.
- **Keep handwriting practice short and positive.** A few well-formed letters beats a page of frustration. Quality over quantity.
- **Reduce copying from the board.** Provide notes or a printed copy so energy goes into learning, not copying.

Praise the ideas, not the neatness. The ideas are the point.

When it's worth seeking support

Consider reaching out if, over time, you notice:

- › Writing that is painful, exhausting or very slow
- › Strong avoidance of any writing task
- › A big gap between spoken ability and written work
- › Letter formation that isn't improving with practice

How The Lodestone Centre can help

We start with an optional screening to see whether it's the motor side, the planning side, or both, then build letter formation, grip and fine-motor skills, and give your child strategies (including typing) to get ideas onto the page.

Programs that often help: Writing & Handwriting Program, Screening, Reading & Literacy Program, Progressive Coding, SEL Program.

Free 15-minute call · WhatsApp 012-212 7743 · thelodestonesolution.com

This guide is for general information and to support parents. The Lodestone Centre provides educational support, screening and programs; it is not a substitute for formal schooling or a clinical diagnosis. If you have concerns about your child's development, a screening or a chat with our team is a good next step.